

MOVIE: SPOILER WARNING

Alita: Battle Angel

★★★★☆ | Manga adaptations to film haven't usually found critical success but *Alita: Battle Angel* changes that. Coming from a collaboration between producer James Cameron and director Robert Rodriguez, the movie is high on action even as it falls short in terms of story.

It starts with Dyson Ido, a surgeon and mechanic who heals (repairs?) cyborgs in Iron City, finding Alita in a scrap yard. He takes her to his medical centre and manages to bring her back to life, however, at the cost of amnesia. With no memory of her past life, she tries to find out more about herself even though Ido tries to protect her from it. Relentless to her pursuits, she realises that facing danger triggers flashes from her memories and she believes this could be how she learns more about herself. The movie is all about Alita figuring out who she is and eventually discovering her purpose in life. During this journey, she also comes across Hugo in the city and love sparks between them.

While the story isn't the strongest, the VFX certainly makes up for an adrenaline rush in a few scenes. They are remarkable, something you would expect from a Cameron movie. From Robert Rodriguez, he brings in the innocence from the *Spy Kids* movies and the violence and gore from *Sin City* to this one. If you're up for some gory and fresh cyborg busting action, you shouldn't miss *Alita: Battle Angel*.



COMIC BOOK: SPOILERS AHOY!

Shaitan #4

★★★★☆ | What started amidst a mystery, slowly unfolded through the consecutive issues of *Shaitan*. In the third issue, we saw flashbacks from the Nazi era of World War II. Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose and Shaitan are seen exchanging dialogue on 'Operation Bajadere' at a Nazi base before Shaitan headed off to a boxing match with Hitler himself in the audience. Back in the present time, we saw a hideous monster, Commander Weirnacht or Kankal, appear from the darkness, whom Shaitan was able to recognise. The fourth and final issue of the Toy Soldiers story arc of *Shaitan* continues with Shaitan punching and ripping apart the monsters attacking him. Lena goes through another phase of flashbacks that proves beneficial at the end. Another flashback sequence from the Nazis shows how the deformed Kankal came to be and what was he exactly working on. Was the final issue a satisfying end? Sort of. Through the story arc, there were many plot points left open and several questions unsolved that are probably intentional to expand on them later.

Holy Cow Entertainment is building a universe where other characters will be introduced in separate issues of their own. There were several single-page panels showing events from different stories of these characters – more like an end-credits scene. All of these characters are going to converge at one point. We look forward to that.



UP AND COMING

COMIC
BOOK

The Batman Who Laughs: Grim Knight



The new spin-off mini-series after the events *Dark Nights: Metal* introduced a gun-wielding Batman who shows mercy to criminals in his universe by way of death. Now he got his own one-shot that will detail his origins.

Release date: March 13, 2019.

TV SHOW

American Gods Season 2



In the first season, Mr Wednesday went all out recruiting the old gods to fight alongside him in the war between the old and new gods. Next season is where things get serious.

Release date: March 10, 2019.

MOVIE

Captain Marvel



Set in the '90s, Carol Danvers aka Captain Marvel becomes part of an intergalactic war between two alien races while she turns into the universe's most powerful superhero.

Release date: March 8, 2019.